Romeo and Juliet: Introduction and Historical Background

Video: Romeo and Juliet: Introduction and Historical Background (Shakespeare) (Edpuzzle Original)

A Story Retold

Romeo and Juliet is literature's most famous story of _____: two teens fall in love despite their families' ancient _____.

A key source for Shakespeare was Arthur Brooke's The Tragical History of _____. The idea goes back to Ovid's tale of _____.

The play is a _____: a story of human suffering whose characters are brought down by their own flaws or _____.

Shakespeare's Language

Term	Meaning
	one unstressed and one stressed syllable repeated five times
	conversational lines that are not poetry; lines can begin with lowercase letters
	a humorous play on a word with more than one meaning

Rhyme is a clue that characters are talking about something _____, like love and death.

Prose is used by _____ characters, and by wealthy characters when they are having fun.

The Elizabethan World

Shakespeare lived during the _____ era, the reign of Queen Elizabeth I (1558-1603).

Society was organized by the extended family, so family _____ was a must. Marriage was seen as a _____ that helped noble families form alliances. Society was _____ (male-dominated), so fathers chose their daughters' husbands. Nobles learned _____ to defend their family's name and honor.

Setting the Stage

The play is set in 14th-century _____, Italy.

The _____ is an introductory speech written as a _____, a 14-line poem in iambic pentameter.

The prologue calls Romeo and Juliet _____ lovers, meaning ill-fated.

House of Montague	House of Capulet	Neither house
Romeo, Benvolio (cousin), Mercutio (friend)	Juliet, [[Tybalt]] (cousin), the Nurse	Prince Escalus, [[Friar Lawrence]]

_____ is the idea that our life's path is predetermined.

Your view: How much control do we have over our own lives? _____

Answer Key

A Story Retold

- forbidden love, feud
- Romeus and Juliet, Pyramus and Thisbe
- tragedy, fate

Shakespeare's Language

- Table: Row 1: iambic pentameter; Row 2: prose; Row 3: pun
- important
- lower-status

The Elizabethan World

- Elizabethan
- loyalty, business deal, patriarchal, fencing

Setting the Stage

- Verona
- prologue, sonnet
- star-crossed
- Fate
- answers will vary